

The E-R-T Framework™ Reference Card

REFERENCE CARD — KEEP THIS AT YOUR DESK

Run every AI hiring decision through all three gates. If it can't pass all three — it's not ready.

Every ethical AI decision in HR runs through three gates. If it fails even one — the tool is not ready to deploy.

E

EQUITY

Does this tool produce fair outcomes across all protected classes?

Ask before launch:

- What data was this trained on? Who is represented?
- Run a disparate impact test — apply the 4/5ths rule
- Is an opt-out pathway available for candidates?
- Re-audit scheduled within 90 days of launch?

PASS: Selection rate gap <20% across all groups. **FAIL:** Any group below 80% of top group. Do not launch.

R

RELIABILITY

Does it work consistently — and do we know when it breaks?

Ask before launch:

- Does the system alert on failed applications or drop silently?
- Can recruiters override any AI score and move a candidate forward?
- Is a 14-day max bias-incident SLA in the contract?
- Is a right-to-audit clause included?

PASS: Error logging active, overrides in place, SLA documented. **FAIL:** Silent failures, no override, no SLA.

T

TRANSPARENCY

Can candidates, employees, and regulators see how it works?

Ask before launch:

- Written candidate disclosure in all job postings and rejection emails?
- Can the system explain why any candidate was scored the way they were?
- AI use policy documented and available to employees?
- AI ethics policy added to the employee handbook?

PASS: Disclosure published, scoring explainable, policy documented. **FAIL:** No disclosure. 'Algorithm said so' is not an answer.

QUICK-DECISION TABLE — IS THIS TOOL READY?

Situation	Gates	Your Move
All three gates pass	E ✓ R ✓ T ✓	Launch. Schedule 90-day re-audit. Document everything.

Equity fails only	E ✗ R ✓ T ✓	Do not launch. Fix training data or model. Re-test.
Reliability fails only	E ✓ R ✗ T ✓	Do not launch. Require error logging + override controls. Re-test.
Transparency fails only	E ✓ R ✓ T ✗	Delay launch. Draft disclosure + explainability docs. 2-week fix.
Multiple gates fail	E ✗ R ✗ T ✗	Do not launch. Re-evaluate the vendor entirely.

“E-R-T isn’t a checklist you do once before launch — it’s the ongoing operating system for how your HR team relates to AI. If you can’t answer yes to all three on any given Tuesday, the tool isn’t ready for that Tuesday.”

— Alaric Scott Jr. | Founder & CEO, AIAJ Academy | Creator, EquiHire AI